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Credit - Drishti Ias

E175 Jets in India

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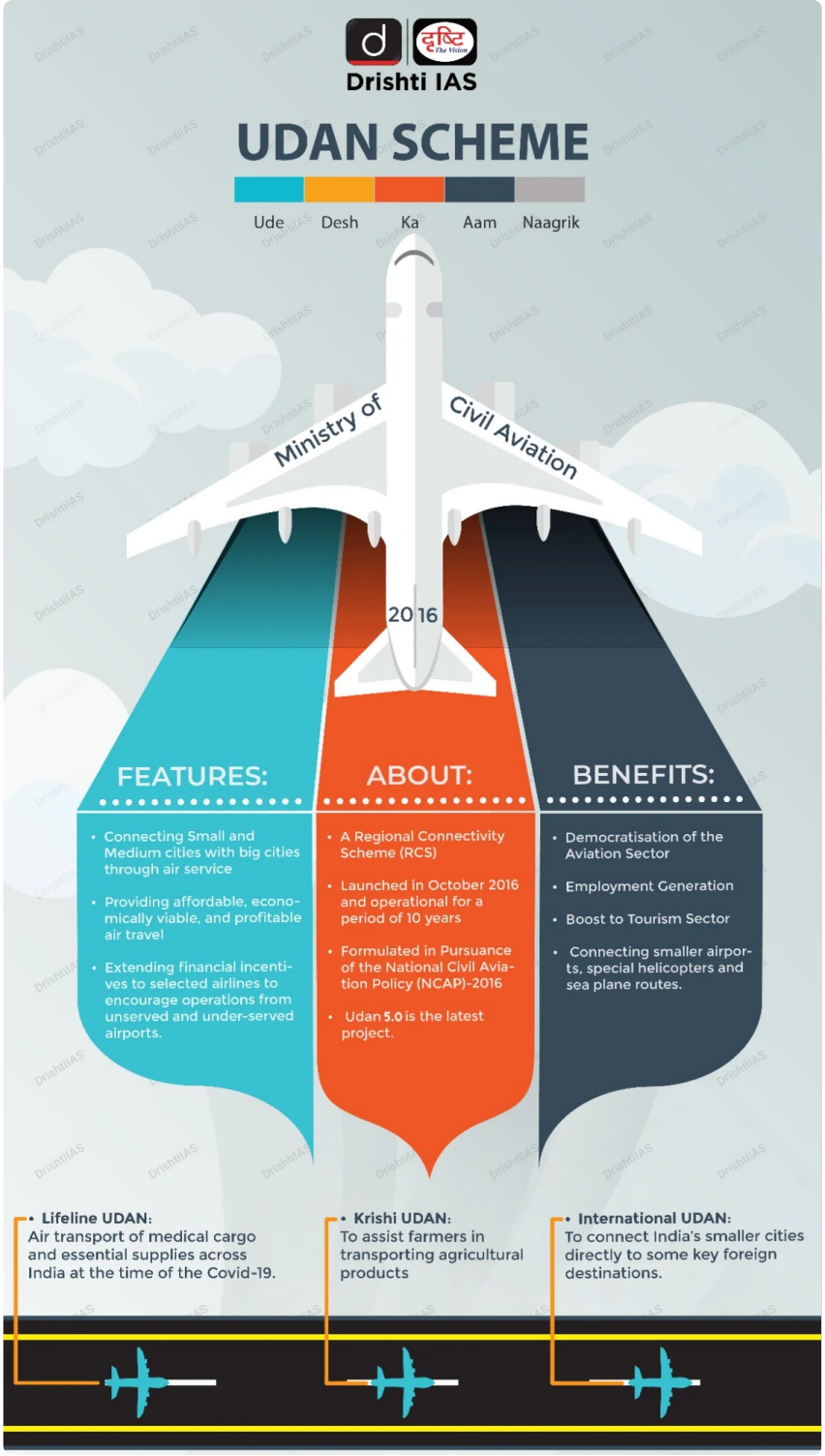
Source: BS

In a major push for **" Make in India "** in the aviation sector, **Adani Defence & Aerospace** and Brazil's **Embraer** have signed an enhanced MoU to establish a **Final Assembly Line (FAL)** for **E175 regional jets** in India.

- The partnership aims to build a comprehensive **Regional Transport Aircraft (RTA) ecosystem** , covering manufacturing, supply chain management, and pilot training.
- **E175 Jet:** The **E175 jet** , with a seating capacity of up to **88 passengers** , is specifically designed for high-frequency operations connecting **Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities** .
  - India is projected to require at least **500 aircraft** in the 80–146 seat segment over the next two decades.
- **Support for UDAN Scheme:** The project aligns with the **Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS-UDAN)** , addressing the critical need for an indigenous aviation ecosystem to support economic expansion in underserved markets.
- **Industrial Scope:** Beyond assembly, the collaboration focuses on **aftermarket services** and securing orders to sustain the viability of the proposed assembly line.



Read more: UDAN Scheme

V.O. Chidambaranar Port

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Source: PIB

The Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways inaugurated and laid the foundation for infrastructure and green energy projects worth over **Rs 1,500 crore** at **V.O. Chidambaranar (VOC) Port** in **Tuticorin** , Tamil Nadu.

- **VOC Port:** Originally known as **Tuticorin Port,** it was renamed in 2011 to honor **V.O. Chidambaranar,** the legendary freedom fighter who launched the **Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company in 1906** to challenge the **British maritime monopoly.**
  - VOC Port is an **artificial, all-weather deep-sea port located on the Coromandel Coast,** playing a pivotal role in India's maritime trade with the Mediterranean region, Europe, and the United States.
- **Location:** VOC Port, located on the **Coromandel Coast in the Gulf of Mannar** , is an **artificial, all-weather deep-sea port** strategically positioned near the **East–West international sea route,** giving it a strong advantage in India's trade with the Mediterranean, Europe, and the US.
- **Sheltered Waters:** VOC Port is **naturally sheltered from storms and cyclones** due to the presence of Sri Lanka to its southeast.
- **Port Modernaisation:** It is the first Indian port to produce and use **green hydrogen on-site** , with a pilot project active since late 2025.
  - It is the first in India to deploy a **Digital Twin platform** , creating a real-time virtual replica of port operations for predictive maintenance and data-driven optimization.
  - In **February 2026** , it became the first Indian port to implement an **advanced anti-drone system** using radar and radio frequency technologies to safeguard critical infrastructure.
- **Cultural Preservation:** The **VOC Maritime Heritage Museum** serves as a cultural landmark, highlighting the maritime history of the Coromandel Coast.
- **Outer Harbour Project:** Current expansions aim to handle larger **vessels and mega-carriers** , positioning the port as a future transshipment hub of South India.

Read more: **Indian Ports Act, 2025**

Anjadip Vessel

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Source: PIB

The **Indian Navy** is set to commission **Anjadip** , an indigenous **Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC)** at **Eastern Naval Command** at Chennai Port, reinforcing its capabilities to counter **underwater threats** in the vital **littoral waters** .

- **Strategic Importance:** Anjadip is the 3 rd of eight ships in the **ASW-SWC project** , representing a major step towards ' **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** ' in defence. It is built by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata** .
  - It marks another key milestone in the transformation of the **Indian Navy** into a formidable **'Builder's Navy'** , emphasizing **self-reliance** in warship construction.
- **Primary Role & Nickname:** It has been engineered to function as a **'Dolphin Hunter'** , tasked with detecting, tracking, and neutralizing **enemy submarines** in coastal areas.
- **Indigenous Weaponry & Sensors:** The warship is equipped with a **state-of-the-art indigenous weapons and sensor package** , which includes the **Hull Mounted Sonar 'Abhay'** , alongside **Lightweight Torpedoes** and **ASW Rockets** .
  - Beyond its core **ASW function** , the highly manoeuvrable ship is capable of conducting **Coastal Surveillance** , **Low-Intensity Maritime Operations (LIMO)** , and **Search & Rescue (SAR)** missions.
  - It features a **high-speed Water-Jet Propulsion system** , allowing it to achieve a **top speed of 25 knots** for rapid response.
- **Significance of Anjadip Island:** The vessel is named after the **Anjadip Island** (part of Goa), which is strategically located in the Arabian Sea. **Vasco da Gama** claimed the island as **Portuguese crown territory** on **24 th September, 1498** , during his **first voyage to India** .

Read More: **Indigenisation Efforts of Navy**